

The Program in Action

When you run *countdown.py*, the output will look like this:

```
|_| |_| * |_| |_| * |_| |_|
|_| |_| * |_| |_| * |_| |_|
```

Press Ctrl-C to quit.

How It Works

After running `import sevseg`, you can call the `sevseg.getSevSegStr()` function to get a multiline string of the seven segment digits. However, the Countdown program needs to display a colon made out of asterisks in between the hours, minutes, and seconds. This requires splitting up the three lines of the multiline strings for these digits into three separate strings with the `splitlines()` method.

```
1. """Countdown, by Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com
2. Show a countdown timer animation using a seven-segment display.
3. Press Ctrl-C to stop.
4. More info at https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Seven-segment\_display
5. Requires sevseg.py to be in the same folder.
6. View this code at https://nostarch.com/big-book-small-python-projects
7. Tags: tiny, artistic"""
8.
9. import sys, time
10. import sevseg # Imports our sevseg.py program.
11.
12. # (!) Change this to any number of seconds:
13. secondsLeft = 30
14.
15. try:
16.     while True: # Main program loop.
17.         # Clear the screen by printing several newlines:
18.         print('\n' * 60)
19.
20.         # Get the hours/minutes/seconds from secondsLeft:
21.         # For example: 7265 is 2 hours, 1 minute, 5 seconds.
22.         # So 7265 // 3600 is 2 hours:
23.         hours = str(secondsLeft // 3600)
24.         # And 7265 % 3600 is 65, and 65 // 60 is 1 minute:
25.         minutes = str((secondsLeft % 3600) // 60)
26.         # And 7265 % 60 is 5 seconds:
27.         seconds = str(secondsLeft % 60)
28.
29.         # Get the digit strings from the sevseg module:
30.         hDigits = sevseg.getSevSegStr(hours, 2)
31.         hTopRow, hMiddleRow, hBottomRow = hDigits.splitlines()
32.
33.         mDigits = sevseg.getSevSegStr(minutes, 2)
34.         mTopRow, mMiddleRow, mBottomRow = mDigits.splitlines()
```